Toluene (Asia)

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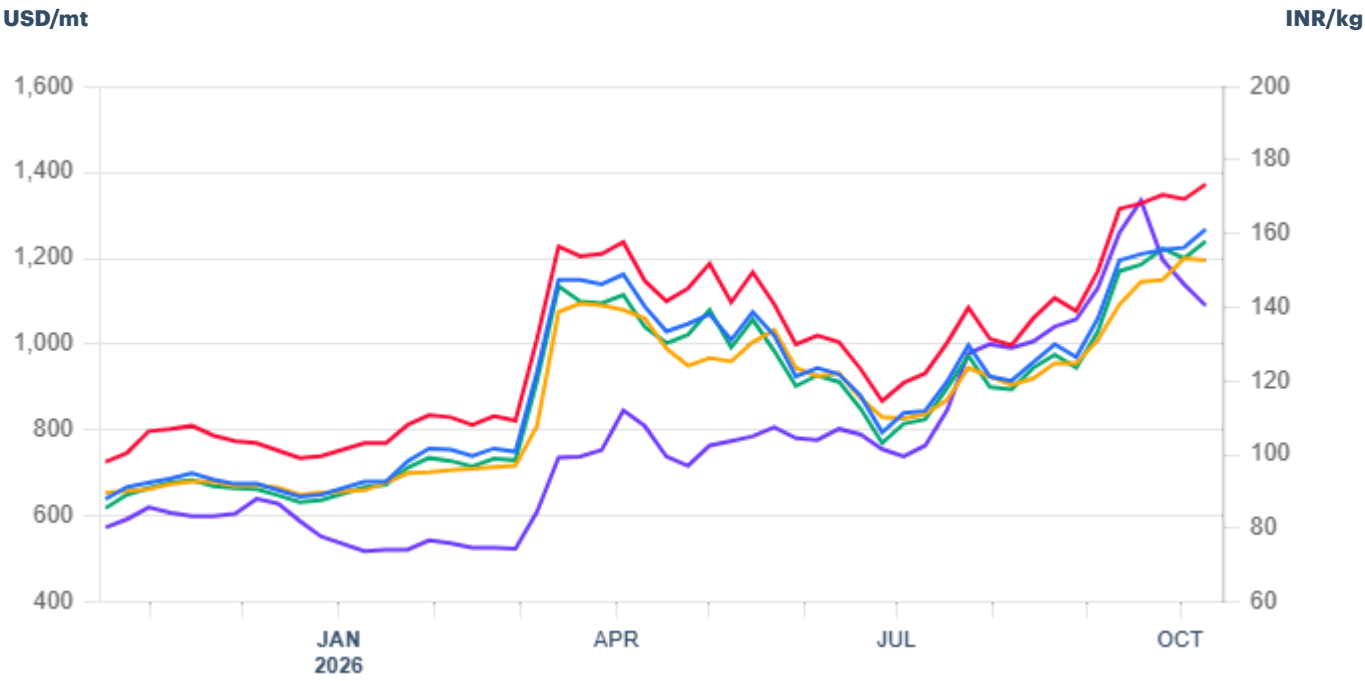
Market overview

AS OF 9 OCT 2026

Highlights

- NE Asia export markets rise on supply constraints
- Cargo arrivals tilt India inventory balance
- Cautious solvents sector buying appetite caps upward pressure

Toluene



Left axis

- Toluene CFR Asia NE Spot
- Toluene CFR India Spot
- Toluene FOB China Spot
- Toluene FOB South Korea Spot

Right axis

- Toluene Ex-Tank India Spot

Market commentary

Asia-Pacific toluene prices took cues from volatile upstream global crude oil futures, as renewed hostilities in the Middle East shutting down production raised supply worries.

Upstream refined product spreads for jet kerosene and diesel continue to outperform gasoline, encouraging refiners to maximize middle distillate yields and consequently constraining aromatics production from reforming units.

Toluene values in the US remain elevated, making economics viable on the arbitrage front that might attract flows from northeast Asia, while market dynamics remain sensitive to geopolitical developments surrounding feedstock and global energy flows.

Healthy demand for gasoline-blending and solvents sector applications in southeast Asia and India provided market support.

Downstream theoretical margins for toluene and xylenes production remained below healthy threshold levels (see Downstream section).

Outlook

- ICIS forecasts Asia benzene to trend down as feedstock costs ease
- Supply constraint concerns could outweigh regional demand
- Geopolitical developments, risk cost premium to remain drivers in demand and supply

Prices

AS OF 14 OCT 2026

Daily

Spot prices

Name	Unit	Low change	Low price	High price	High change	Mid price	Mid change	Frequency	Published
Toluene FOB South Korea Spot Day Close-Weighted Range	USD/mt	-5 (-0.4%)	1,235 ▼	1,245 ▼	-5 (-0.4%)	1,240 ▼	-5 (-0.4%)	Daily	14 Oct 2026
Toluene FOB China Spot	USD/mt	-30 (-2.54%)	1,150 ▼	1,230 ●	0 (0%)	1,190 ▼	-15 (-1.24%)	Daily	14 Oct 2026
Toluene Ex-Tank China E Spot	CNY/mt	+70 (+0.78%)	9,050 ▲	9,060 ▲	+40 (+0.44%)	9,055 ▲	+55 (+0.61%)	Daily	14 Oct 2026
Toluene Ex-Tank India Spot Day Close-Weighted Range	INR/kg	0 (0%)	139 ●	142 ▲	+2 (+1.43%)	140.5 ▲	+1 (+0.72%)	Daily	14 Oct 2026

Weekly

Spot prices - price range at close of the week

Name	Unit	Low change	Low price	High price	High change	Mid price	Mid change	Frequency	Published
Toluene FOB South Korea Spot Week Close-Weighted Range	USD/mt	+40 (+3.36%)	1,230 ▲	1,250 ▲	+40 (+3.31%)	1,240 ▲	+40 (+3.33%)	Weekly	09 Oct 2026
Toluene FOB China Spot Week Close-Weighted Range	USD/mt	-20 (-1.68%)	1,170 ▼	1,220 ▲	+10 (+0.83%)	1,195 ▼	-5 (-0.42%)	Weekly	09 Oct 2026
Toluene CFR Asia NE Spot Week Close-Weighted Range	USD/mt	+50 (+4.15%)	1,255 ▲	1,280 ▲	+35 (+2.81%)	1,267.5 ▲	+42.5 (+3.47%)	Weekly	09 Oct 2026
Toluene CFR Asia SE Spot Week Close-Weighted Range	USD/mt	+30 (+2.4%)	1,280 ▲	1,320 ▲	+40 (+3.13%)	1,300 ▲	+35 (+2.77%)	Weekly	09 Oct 2026
Toluene Ex-Tank China E Spot Week Close	CNY/mt	+230 (+2.61%)	9,050 ▲	9,080 ▲	+230 (+2.6%)	9,065 ▲	+230 (+2.6%)	Weekly	09 Oct 2026
Toluene CFR India Spot Week Close-Weighted Range	USD/mt	+25 (+1.89%)	1,350 ▲	1,395 ▲	+45 (+3.33%)	1,372.5 ▲	+35 (+2.62%)	Weekly	09 Oct 2026
Toluene Ex-Tank India Spot Week Close-Weighted Range	INR/kg	-2 (-1.38%)	143 ▼	144 ▼	-1.5 (-1.03%)	143.5 ▼	-1.75 (-1.2%)	Weekly	09 Oct 2026

Spot prices - price range for the week

Name	Unit	Low change	Low price	High price	High change	Mid price	Mid change	Frequency	Published
Toluene FOB South Korea Spot	USD/mt	+20 (+1.68%)	1,210 ▲	1,250 ▲	+25 (+2.04%)	1,230 ▲	+22.5 (+1.86%)	Weekly	09 Oct 2026
Toluene FOB China Spot	USD/mt	-20 (-1.68%)	1,170 ▼	1,220 ▲	+10 (+0.83%)	1,195 ▼	-5 (-0.42%)	Weekly	09 Oct 2026
Toluene CFR Asia NE Spot	USD/mt	+50 (+4.15%)	1,255 ▲	1,280 ▲	+35 (+2.81%)	1,267.5 ▲	+42.5 (+3.47%)	Weekly	09 Oct 2026
Toluene CFR Asia SE Spot	USD/mt	+30 (+2.4%)	1,280 ▲	1,320 ▲	+40 (+3.13%)	1,300 ▲	+35 (+2.77%)	Weekly	09 Oct 2026
Toluene Ex-Tank China E Spot	CNY/mt	+230 (+2.62%)	9,000 ▲	9,080 ▲	+90 (+1%)	9,040 ▲	+160 (+1.8%)	Weekly	09 Oct 2026
Toluene CFR India Spot	USD/mt	+25 (+1.89%)	1,350 ▲	1,395 ▲	+45 (+3.33%)	1,372.5 ▲	+35 (+2.62%)	Weekly	09 Oct 2026
Toluene Ex-Tank India Spot	INR/kg	-8 (-5.52%)	137 ▼	144 ▼	-3.5 (-2.37%)	140.5 ▼	-5.75 (-3.93%)	Weekly	09 Oct 2026

Pricing commentary

Daily

South Korea

Open trading session saw limited firm offers for November loading cargoes. Upstream global crude oil futures were choppy amid hostilities in the Middle East keeping supply fears intact.

A fire that occurred at a chemical product storage tank in Ulsan had no major impact in rattling market fundamentals.

Constrained spot supply on the back of curbed feedstock cracker production served to moderate the downward pressure in prices, aligned with market discussions.

China

On the export front, selling indications of November loading shipment were at around $1,230/tonne FOB China, while sporadic buying interest was captured at the low-end of the FOB China range.

Regional demand was viewed as relatively cautious appetite amid volatility in upstream global crude oil prices.

India

Domestic markets were characterised as stable in demand, with cargo flows incoming from northeast Asia envisaged to rebalance inventory levels.

Market discussions were captured on the ex-tank range.

Weekly

Northeast Asia

Daily FOB South Korea prices ($/tonne)

Date	Day	FOB S Korea Low	FOB S Korea High
05 Oct	Monday	1220	1231
06 Oct	Tuesday	**1210**	1215
07 Oct	Wednesday	1210	1215
08 Oct	Thursday	1220	**1250**
09 Oct	Friday	1230	1250

South Korea export markets moved alongside gains in global crude oil futures on the back of renewed military attacks in the Middle East stoking supply worries.

Curbed cracker production in the region combined with rationalization reined in supply, while market discussions for November-loading cargoes edged up during the week.

FOB China

Daily FOB China prices ($/tonne)

Date	Day	FOB China Low	FOB China High
05 Oct	Monday	--	--
06 Oct	Tuesday	--	--
07 Oct	Wednesday	--	--
08 Oct	Thursday	1170	**1220**
09 Oct	Friday	**1170**	1220

China export markets tracked an uptrend in global crude oil prices, with rising tension in the Middle East stoking supply concerns.

Constrained supply amid curbed production while demand held buoyant fueled market sentiment, providing a floor to export prices.

Over in east China, inventories of toluene rose from end-September to 16,400 tonnes on the back of increased cargo arrivals.

Southeast Asia

Buying appetite for gasoline-blending purposes and in the solvents sector was viewed as healthy, aiding in supporting prices while upstream oil markets and feedstock security concerns kept sentiment upbeat.

Buy-sell indications for November shipments were captured on the CFR southeast Asia range, factoring in business negotiated and sustained risk-cost pressures.

India

India domestic markets were down though prices improved later in the week, lifted by elevated upstream crude oil price gains along with steady demand that generated upward pressure on prices.

Upcoming buying gathering pace ahead of the Diwali holidays buoyed sentiment. Incoming cargo arrivals aided in rebalancing earlier supply shortfalls.

Spot discussions on a floating basis were at premiums in the low $140s/tonne to spot FOB South Korea quotes, captured on the CFR India price range.

Supply and demand

AS OF 14 OCT 2026

Highlights

- China domestic inventories rise on increased cargo arrivals
- Constrained supply drives spot values
- Buoyant gasoline-blending demand provides support

Capacity and shutdowns



Unit: '000 tonnes

Shutdowns

Commodity type	Location	Company	Site	Start	End	Plant No.	Cause	Capacity loss	Total annual capacity (kt)	Last updated
Styrene	Taiwan	Formosa Chemicals and Fibre Corp.	Mai Liao	06 Jun 2025 (Market information)	01 Oct 2026 (Market information)	1	Scheduled	100% (est. 330.8 kt)	250	08 Jan 2026
Toluene	China	Sinopec Yangzi PC	Nanjing	10 May 2026 (Market information)	31 Dec 2026 (Assumptions)	1	Scheduled	100% (est. 194.0 kt)	300	03 Aug 2026
Toluene	China	Sinopec Yangzi PC	Nanjing	10 May 2026 (Market information)	31 Dec 2026 (Assumptions)	3	Scheduled	100% (est. 64.7 kt)	100	03 Aug 2026
Toluene	China	Sinopec Yangzi PC	Nanjing	10 May 2026 (Market information)	31 Dec 2026 (Assumptions)	5	Scheduled	100% (est. 181.0 kt)	280	03 Aug 2026
Styrene	Japan	Idemitsu Kosan	Tokuyama	29 Aug 2026 (Market information)	29 Oct 2026 (Market information)	1	Scheduled	100% (est. 20.4 kt)	120	18 Sep 2026
Styrene	Japan	Idemitsu Kosan	Tokuyama	29 Aug 2026 (Market information)	29 Oct 2026 (Market information)	2	Scheduled	100% (est. 37.4 kt)	220	18 Sep 2026
Styrene	Taiwan	Grand Pacific Petrochemical Corp.	Ta-sheh City	29 Aug 2026 (Market information)	16 Oct 2026 (Market information)	2	Scheduled	100% (est. 17.5 kt)	130	04 Sep 2026
Styrene	China	Sinopec Anqing PC Co	Anqing	02 Sep 2026 (Market information)	15 Nov 2026 (Market information)	2	Scheduled	100% (est. 82.2 kt)	400	07 Sep 2026
Toluene	China	Sinopec Anqing PC Co	Anqing	05 Sep 2026 (Market information)	04 Nov 2026 (Market information)	1	Scheduled	100% (est. 25.1 kt)	150	08 Sep 2026
Toluene	China	Sinopec Anqing PC Co	Anqing	05 Sep 2026 (Market information)	04 Nov 2026 (Market information)	2	Scheduled	100% (est. 50.1 kt)	300	08 Sep 2026
Styrene	Taiwan	Formosa Chemicals and Fibre Corp.	Mai Liao	07 Sep 2026 (Market information)	16 Jun 2027 (Market information)	2	Scheduled	30% (est. 81.4 kt)	350	11 Sep 2026
Styrene	Taiwan	Taiwan Styrene Monomer	LIN Yuan	01 Oct 2026 (Market information)	31 Oct 2027 (Market information)	1	Scheduled	100% (est. 195.3 kt)	180	01 Oct 2026
Styrene	Taiwan	Taiwan Styrene Monomer	LIN Yuan	01 Oct 2026 (Market information)	31 Oct 2027 (Market information)	2	Scheduled	100% (est. 173.6 kt)	160	01 Oct 2026

Commodity type	Location	Company	Site	Start	End	Plant No.	Cause	Capacity loss	Total annual capacity (kt)	Last updated
Toluene	Thailand	Rayong Olefins	Map Ta Phut	01 Oct 2026 (Market information)	30 Nov 2026 (Market information)	1	Scheduled	100% (est. 13.4 kt)	80	13 Feb 2026

Capacity changes

Location	Company	Site	Plant No.	Type	Estimated start	New annual capacity (kt)	Capacity change (kt)	% Change	Last updated
China	Huajin Aramco Petrochemical	Panjin	1	New Plant	Jun 2027	700 ▲	700	100.00%	14 Oct 2026
China	Bright Lyondellbasell Petrochemical	Panjin	1	Expansion	Aug 2027	420 ▲	70	20.00%	22 Jul 2026

Value chain commentary

Upstream

The **crude oil** benchmark remained higher over the week on intensified attacks on ships in Middle Eastern waterways. However US president Trump's claims that the US will not attack Iran before the November US elections provides a floor.

China will resume refined fuels exports.

Hurricane Isaias in the Gulf of Mexico has caused oil producers to shut down 62.9% of production.

Click here for the Asia feedstocks and petrochemicals weekly summary.

China's shore tank inventories in tonnes

	30-Sep	8-Oct	% change
Jiangsu	7,300	16,400	124.66
	30-Sep	**8-Oct**	**% change**
Consumption	2,400	6,200	158.33
Arrival (import + domestic trf)	6,000	15,300	155.00

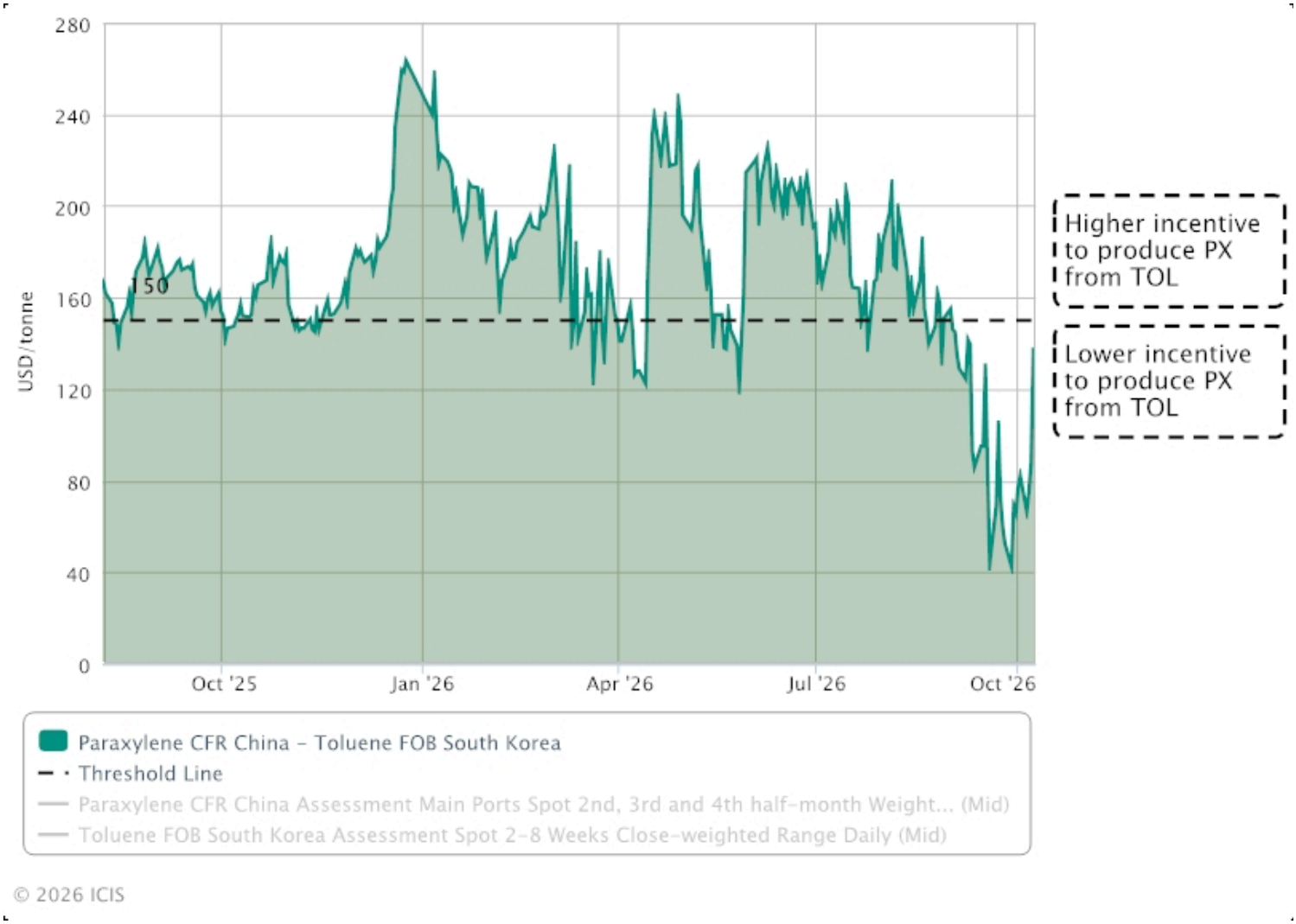
Production

Click here for the **Live Disruptions Tracker.**

Downstream

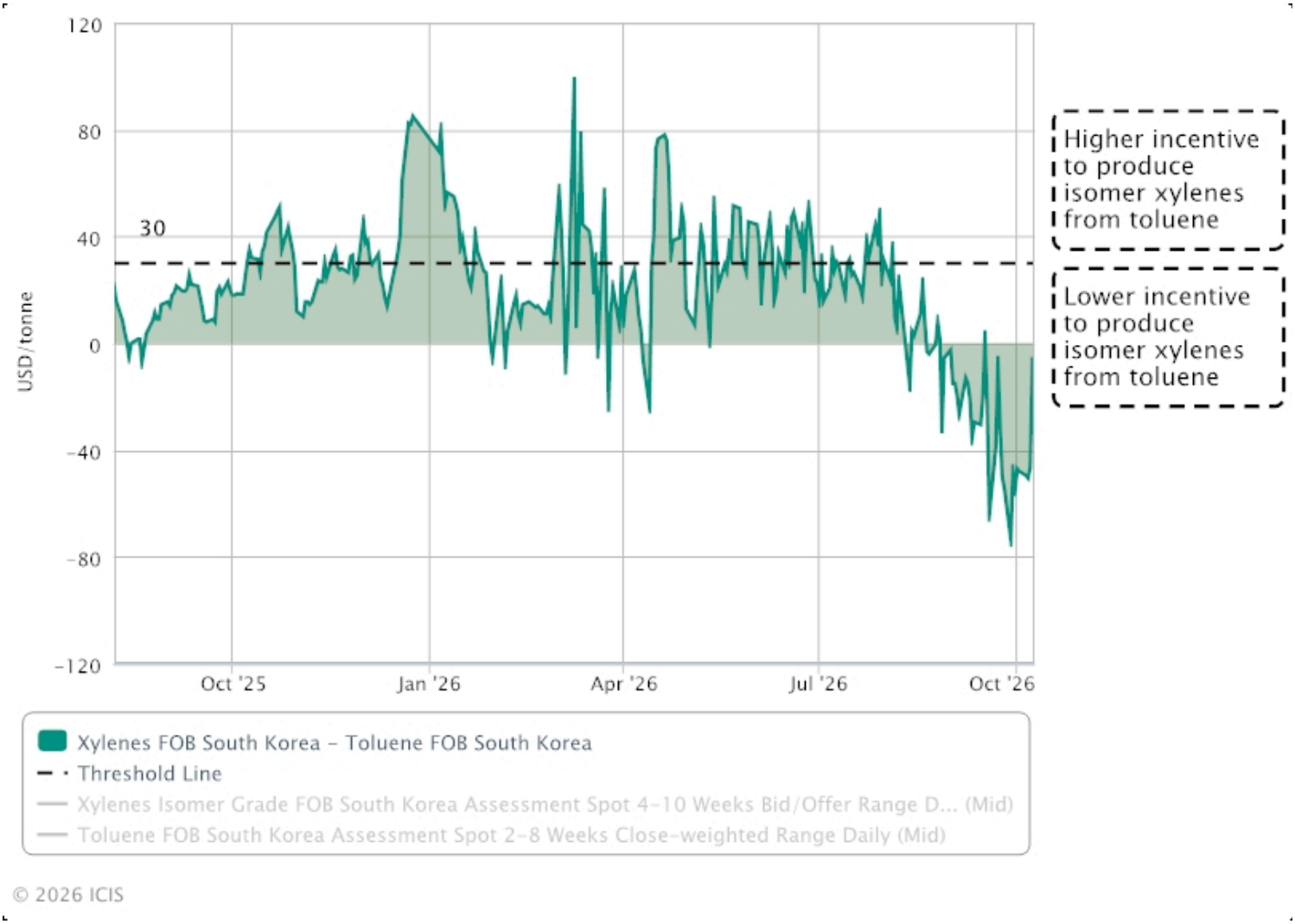
Benzene spot prices in South Korea and China reached more than four-year highs. Post-holiday restocking coincided with crude oil price gains. Market concerns grow over benzene availability on feedstock outbound flows for gasoline blending.

Downstream spread - Toluene and PX Asia



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Downstream spread - Toluene and MX Korea

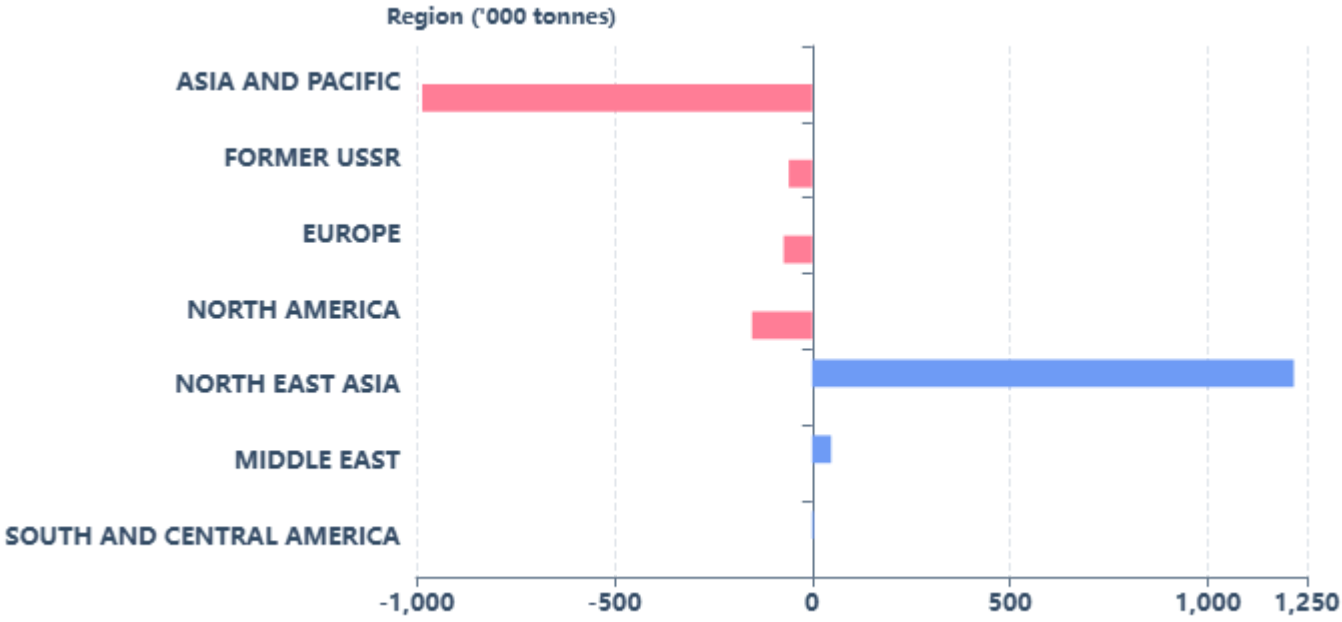


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Trade balance

AS OF 21 AUG 2026

Toluene global net trade forecast 2026



Net Exports

Net Imports

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